

Kefei Duan

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Vision-Language-Action Model, Embodied Agent

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, MO, USA

Aug. 2023 - Present

PhD candidate, Major in Computer Science

Advised by [Prof. Chongjie Zhang](#)

Peking University, Beijing, China

Sep. 2019 - Jul. 2023

Bachelor of Science in Intelligence Science and Technology

GPA: 3.741/4.0 (Rank: 10/81)

Advised by [Prof. Ming Zhang](#)

PUBLICATIONS

Heng Dong*, **Kefei Duan***, Chongjie Zhang. Enhancing Decision-Making of Large Language Models via Actor-Critic. ICML 2025.

Eric Pasewark, Kyle Montgomery, **Kefei Duan**, Dawn Song, Chenguang Wang. Re-Tuning: Overcoming the Compositionality Limits of Large Language Models with Recursive Tuning. ACL 2024.

Zequn Liu, **Kefei Duan**, Junwei Yang, Hanwen Xu, Ming Zhang, Sheng Wang. MetaFill: Text Infilling for Meta-Path Generation on Heterogeneous Information Networks. EMNLP 2022.

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Aug. 2021 - Jun. 2022

Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering, University of Washington, Seattle

Research Intern

Nov. 2021 - Nov. 2022

Montreal Institute for Learning Algorithms (MILA), University of Montreal

Research Intern

Jul. 2022 - Sep. 2022 / Feb. 2023 - Jun. 2023

Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering, University of Washington, Seattle

Research Intern

May. 2021 - Jul. 2023

Dlib, Peking University, Beijing, China

AWARDS

China Merchants Securities Scholarship (Beijing, Peking University)

Sep. 2022

Merit Student Award (Beijing, Peking University)

Sep. 2022

National Inspirational Scholarship (Beijing, Peking University)

Oct. 2022

National Scholarship

Sep. 2021

* Highest scholarship awarded by the Chinese government, <0.1%

Merit Student Award (Beijing, Peking University)

Sep. 2021

Third Class Scholarship (Beijing, Peking University)

Sep. 2020

Merit Student Award (Beijing, Peking University)

Sep. 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, Matlab

Softwares/Platforms/Libraries: PyTorch

Research Tools: LaTeX, GitHub